Proponent's Argument

Clean Up City Hall is a package of Props A, D, E and F to improve neighborhood services, speed up permitting and reduce wasteful spending so we can invest in our great city.

PROPOSITION D GIVES MORE VOTERS A VOICE ON WHAT APPEARS ON BALLOTS.

Currently a minority of supervisors, just 2% of voters or the mayor acting alone, can throw anything on the ballot without public input, transparency or proven community support.

"Even well-intentioned ideas can include mistakes and unintended consequences." - Ben Hur, former SF Ethics Chair.

San Francisco is the only city in California that allows these low thresholds — and that's why we have the longest and most confusing ballots in the state.

PROP D REQUIRES MORE TRANSPARENCY, COMPROMISE & COMMUNITY INPUT.

Proposition D requires a public vote of the majority of supervisors or signatures from 8% of voters. It removes the mayor's sole authority to place measures on the ballot to ensure a fair balance of power. The signature requirement remains below the state standard of 10% and neighboring cities like Oakland.

THE RESULT OF THESE MODEST REFORMS WILL BE MORE OPEN DEBATE AND CITIZEN PARTICIPATION BEFORE MEASURES ARE ON THE BALLOT.

San Francisco works best when we work in coalitions together. Please join the citywide coalition to make the system accountable to all!

Mayor Daniel Lurie
Board of Supervisors President Rafael Mandelman
Speaker Emerita Nancy Pelosi
Nancy Tung, San Francisco Democratic Party
Former SF Ethics Chair Ben Hur
Former Deputy City Attorney Jim Lazarus
SFSU Associate Professor of Political Science Jason McDaniel
Former City Controller Ben Rosenfield
Former Fire Chief Joanne Hayes-White
*Dan Calamuci, Carpenters Local 22**
*Anthony Travis Jr., Laborers Local 261**
*Charles Lavery, Operating Engineers Local 3**
Teamsters Local 665
Council of District Merchant Associations
Chinatown History and Culture Association

*For identification purposes only; author is signing as an individual and not on behalf of an organization.

Rebuttal to Proponent's Argument

No on D: It silences San Francisco voters

Proponents call it "modest reform." A fourfold increase is not modest. It's extreme.

Quadrupling signature requirements from 10,600 to 42,500 will require hiring paid signature firms to qualify and cost one million dollars or more.

That extreme cost will price out neighborhood groups, unions and community advocates from participating in the initiative process.

Proponents have raised $8.6 million, collected from a small number of billionaires and venture capitalists. They can afford the higher costs. But the rest of us can't.

Ending citizen initiatives won't move San Francisco forwards. Instead, it takes us back to 1898, when San Francisco became one of the first California cities to win this right.

If this passes, San Francisco will have the highest signature requirement of any California county. Higher than Los Angeles and San Jose. Over three times higher than statewide measures which require 2.4%.

Proponents want you to believe that raising the threshold from 2% to 8% is modest. But that's like raising your rent from $2000 to $8000. It's extreme – and extremely harmful.

Don't be fooled. Don't rob our right to vote.
Vote NO on D.

San Francisco Labor Council
San Francisco Senior & Disability Action
United Educators of San Francisco
San Francisco Women's Political Committee
San Francisco Tenants Union
Indivisible SF
Coleman Advocates for Children & Youth
San Francisco Rising Action Fund

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Arguments are printed as submitted. Spelling and grammatical errors have not been corrected.

Opponent's Argument

NO ON D: DON'T ROB OUR RIGHT TO VOTE.

Don't be fooled. This isn't about streamlining or state standards. Prop D takes away rights San Franciscans have held for 125 years: to put citizen initiatives on the ballot.

Robbing it away. San Francisco was the first California city to have this right. Now, wealthy tech billionaires are spending millions to take it away. They would quadruple the signatures required from 10,600 to 42,500, a limit so high only the very wealthy can reach it.

Follow the money. Wealthy interests can afford to pay one million dollars to collect 42,500 signatures. Neighborhood groups, labor unions and community advocates will be priced out. We'll lose our voice in the democratic process.

10,600 signatures is tough and fair. Since 1932, around 10,600 signatures have been required to qualify a measure. It's not easy: citizen-initiatives are only 15% of all ballot measures. But when City Hall ignores us, citizens have the power to act. A check and balance.

42,500 signatures is out of reach. It will be impossible for citizen-led, grassroots organizations to qualify a measure. After 125 years, it will silence the voices of some San Franciscans forever.

Citizens' initiatives make a difference. They have increased the minimum wage, ensured large corporations pay their fair share of taxes, provided legal aid for renters facing eviction, banned corrupt contributions to politicians, passed Sunshine laws, established rent control, and funded schools, childcare and affordable housing.

After 125 years of direct democracy, don't let them rob it away. Vote NO on D.

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Rebuttal to Opponent's Argument

D ENDS THE INSIDER MONOPOLY ON POWER AT THE BALLOT

The insiders are misleading voters because their monopoly on power is being challenged. They think the system works great. San Franciscans know the system is broken: keeping us in a constant state of confusion, dividing neighbors, and producing bad outcomes.

D is a set of modest reforms requiring transparency, compromise, and community input before issues get on the ballot so that voters can weigh in on well thought-out measures. None of these reforms add a financial cost.

D REBALANCES POWER TO VOTERS

Currently a minority of supervisors, just 2% of voters, or the mayor acting alone can throw anything on the ballot without public input, transparency, or proven community support. Political insiders exploit these rules regularly. That is why San Francisco has the longest and most confusing ballots in the state.

D REQUIRES TRANSPARENCY, COMPROMISE AND COMMUNITY INPUT.

With D, placing a measure on the ballot requires a public vote of a majority of the Supervisors or a modest amount of signatures. D also removes the mayor's sole authority to place measures on the ballot, ensuring a fair balance of power.

Opponents claim today's rules date to 1932. The Controller's report confirms the current threshold was set in 2022, requiring approximately 9,000 fewer signatures than before. San Francisco will still have one of the lowest signature thresholds in California, including other large cities like Oakland, San Diego, and Long Beach.

Mayor Daniel Lurie
Board of Supervisors President Rafael Mandelman
Former Controller Ben Rosenfield

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